MVP Update Presentation Guidelines

Why Your Project Demo Matters: Simulating a Real-World Scenario:

In any technology or research field, building the product is only half the battle. The other half is communicating your progress, vision, and needs to those who have a stake in your success—clients, managers, or investors (collectively known as "stakeholders"). These demonstration meetings are a standard and essential part of professional life.

This project demo is your chance to experience this process firsthand. It serves several key purposes:

1. **To Showcase Your Progress and Build Trust**: This is your opportunity to prove that you are on the right track. By demonstrating a working part of your project, you build confidence with your stakeholders and show that you are making tangible progress toward your goals.
2. **To Create Alignment and Manage Expectations**: You will present your plan for completing the project. This ensures that everyone is on the same page and agrees with the direction you are heading. It's the best way to avoid surprises at the final deadline.
3. **To Remove Obstacles:** Real-world projects rarely go perfectly. This meeting is the formal time to say, "Here is where we are stuck, and here is our plan on how to move forward, and here is what we need (if any)." Whether you need technical advice, a specific resource, or clarification on a requirement, now is the time to ask.

This exercise is a valuable opportunity to develop your presentation and communication skills in a low-risk environment. Use it to learn how to effectively showcase your technical work and guide your project to a successful conclusion.

You will be assessed on your presentation individually and as a team by your teacher. Your mentor will give feedback to the teacher on your collaboration process as a team and on your individual motivation and problem-solving. Please see assessment rubric for more detailed information.

Components:

1. **Project Scope:**
    - Provide your project's original goal and any revisions your team has made.
    - Pitch the problem and its thorough understanding.
    - Demonstrate the expected tangible outcomes.
2. **Progress Overview:**
    - Pitch your current progress to the company, including a demo.
    - Demonstrate your use of Agile as a framework guiding your progress
3. **Risks and Challenges:**
    - Clearly identify and analyze past, current, and potential risks or limitations encountered or that you may encounter during the project, including tech and non-tech challenges when working with your team.

    - Defend to stakeholders how these challenges have been/will be managed or mitigated.
4. **Next Steps and Planning:**
    - Clearly lay out your analysis of any missing steps and/or modifications required for the remaining project phases based on the current progress from both the technical and soft skills perspective.
    - Be ready to quickly respond to questions from stakeholders.

Presentation Assessment:

- **You will be assessed individually and as a team by both your teacher and your mentor.** Please see assessment rubric for more detailed information.
- You need to take turns in speaking. Shorter, frequent turns of all team members make your presentation as well as Q&A more effective. Each team member needs to demonstrate a thorough understanding of the project and its challenges.

Presentation Format:

- **Total 20 minutes**. The Project Update should be a short, focused presentation, **not exceeding 10 minutes**. This presentation will be followed by **a 10-minute Q&A** by the instructor and the partner company.
- Clearly outline key elements of project progress, insights gained, and modifications proposed.
- Utilize visual aids or slides to enhance clarity and engagement.
- Due to extension issues, **you will not be submitting as PDF-** only PowerPoint.

Feedback Giving and Receiving:

- Each team will give verbal and written feedback to one other team, using the COI(N)S feedback model and submit it as **In-Class Activity#3** and send it to the assessed team.
- Constructive feedback will guide teams in refining their approach for the remaining project.

Attendance Policy

- Attendance is **mandatory** at your scheduled Update Presentation and for the presentation of the other teams on the day when you do not present as you will be in the position of a feedback giver.
- If you are unable to attend due to illness or another serious reason, you must:
    - **Inform the instructors and Anastasiya in advance** of your scheduled presentation time.
    - **Provide appropriate documentation** (e.g., a medical certificate or official note) explaining your absence.

- In such cases, and if your condition allows, you will be provided with a **link to join the presentation online**.
- If you are **incapacitated** or unable to participate even remotely, please communicate this clearly and promptly so that alternative arrangements can be considered. Such situations will be approached on a case-by-case basis.
- Failure to attend without prior notice and documentation will be considered an unexcused absence and may impact your project grade.
- Teams are expected to coordinate internally to ensure that all members are prepared and present unless officially excused.

AI Scale Use: Level 3 – AI Collaboration

Allowed: Presentation drafting, revising, graphics

Not allowed: Unrevised presentations; content generated by AI that is unclear and not understandable to your audience (peers, tech mentors, and course instructors, including non-technical audience like Katka and project coordinators).